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**IMPACT OF NATIONAL EDUCATION POLICY
ON HIGHER EDUCATION IN KARNATAKA*****¹Rashmi and **² Dr. Prakasha D.N**¹Research Scholar, Department of Economics, Field Marshall K.M. Cariappa College, Madikeri-571201²Lecturer, Department of Sociology, Bangalore City University, Bangalore-560001**Abstract:**

The National Education Policy 2020 (NEP) is a comprehensive policy framework formulated by the Government of India to transform the education system in the country. It covers various aspects of education, including higher education. The NEP aims to bring about significant changes in the higher education sector and has the potential to have a substantial impact. NEP, 2020 aim to increase the GER to 100% in preschool to secondary level by 2030 whereas GER in Higher Education including vocational education from 26.3% (2018) to 50% by 2035. The purpose of this paper is to examine the impact of National Education Policy 2020 on rural education and to identify the challenges faced by teachers in higher education in Karnataka. To fulfill this purpose secondary data have been collected. The present study found that the NEP 2020 has the potential to transform higher education by promoting multidisciplinary learning, flexibility, research, innovation, and inclusive education. Its successful implementation can shape a future-ready higher education system that equips students with the necessary skills and knowledge.

Keywords: National Education Policy-2020, Advantages and disadvantages.**I. Introduction:**

The National Education Policy 2020 (NEP) is a comprehensive policy framework formulated by the Government of India to transform the education system in the country. It covers various aspects of education, including higher education. The NEP aims to bring about significant changes in the higher education sector and has the potential to have a substantial impact. Here are some of the key impacts of the NEP on higher education. Also, this policy emphasizes a multidisciplinary approach to higher education, allowing students to choose subjects from different domains. This approach encourages a holistic development of students and enables them to pursue diverse career paths. It promotes the integration of arts and sciences, professional and vocational education, and academic and extracurricular activities. Therefore, NEP recommends the restructuring of undergraduate programs to offer more flexibility and choice to students. This flexibility enables students to customize their education and acquire skills relevant to their career goals. The NEP focuses on enhancing the quality of higher education by setting up a robust accreditation framework. It aims to establish an autonomous body, the National Higher Education Regulatory Authority (NHERA), to oversee the accreditation process and ensure quality standards are maintained across institutions. This emphasis on quality assurance will lead to improved teaching and learning outcomes.

Implementation of NEP-2020

The New Education Policy (NEP) 2020 in India is a comprehensive framework for the reform of the education system in the country. It was approved by the Union Cabinet of India on July 29, 2020, and aims to bring significant changes to the education system at all levels, from school education to higher education. Here is a brief history of the NEP 2020:

Formation of Drafting Committee (2017-2019): In June 2017, the Ministry of Human Resource Development (MHRD) constituted a committee led by Dr. K. Kasturi Rangan to draft a new education policy. The committee conducted consultations with various stakeholders, including experts, educators, and the general public, to gather inputs and recommendations.

Draft New Education Policy (2019): The Draft New Education Policy was submitted by the committee to the Ministry of Human Resource Development in December 2018. The draft document proposed significant changes in various aspects of the education system, such as curriculum, assessment, teacher training, and the use of technology in education.

Public Consultation (2019-2020): After the submission of the draft policy, the MHRD invited feedback and suggestions from the public, including teachers, students, parents, and education experts. Several consultations were held across the country to gather diverse perspectives and inputs for the final policy.

Approval and Announcement (2020): After considering the feedback received during the public consultation process, the final draft of the New Education Policy 2020 was prepared. On July 29, 2020, the Union Cabinet, headed by Prime Minister Narendra Modi, approved the NEP 2020.

Background of the New Education Policy-2020

The union Cabinet, chaired by Prime Minister Narendra Modi, approved the National Education Policy 2020 on July 29, 2020. The policy is based on the Draft National Education Policy 2019, which the Committee for Draft National Education Policy – chaired by Dr. K. Kasturi Rangan, former chairman of the Indian Space Research Organization – submitted to the Ministry of Human Resource Development on December 15, 2018. The four-part National Education Policy covers school education (Part I); higher education (Part II); ‘Other Key Areas of Focus’ (Part III) such as adult education, promoting Indian languages and online education; and ‘Making it Happen’ (Part IV), which discusses the policy’s implementation. NEP will be replacing the 10+2 curriculum structure with a 5+3+3+4 structure. The new system has proposed 12 years of school education with 3 years of pre-schooling/Anganwadi. 3-6 years of age is globally recognized as the crucial age for the mental development of the child.

II. Review of literature

Teena Darbar (2021): discussed about ‘Impact of National Education Policy 2020 on Higher Education’. The main objectives of this are to review the NEP in relation to Higher education, to analyses the impact of NEP on teachers, and also expresses the opportunities and challenges in implementation of NEP and also describes the road ahead to NEP. The NEP is a product of an extensive exercise that strives to achieve 100% gross enrolment ratio by 2030. With an aim to create a more inclusive cohesive and productive nation the

recently unveiled national education policy 2020 has come a groundbreaking reform by the Ministry of human resource development MHRD.

Pavan Kalyani (2020): explained about National Education Policy 2020 and its effects on the stakeholders and also try to bring awareness and future impact of National Education Policy 2020 by asking a series of questions floated on all the available social media and analyzing the same. However, Education plays a powerful role in building nation, education decides the future of the nation, the destiny of its people. The impact will be a long-lasting one in terms of growth and development of the nation.

Vijayalakshmi (2020): The main objective of this study was to find out the ‘Opinion of Teachers on National Education Policy 2020 In India’. This study mainly focused on Discipline of Teachers, Teaching Experience of Teachers and problems faced by the teachers from NEP. So that, 342 respondents were selected also found that the relationship between the agreement and disagreement (opinion) of teachers on the features of NEP 2020 with respect to Gender and Discipline of Teachers were found to be non-significant and Teaching Experience of Teachers were found to be significant. Implementing new educational policy in the Indian educational system will make a drastic change and provide a high-quality education to all. Then it will also produce an all-round development of the future students.

Research Gap

Many of the studies have undertaken after implementing NEP 2020 but majority of the studies related to impact of NEP 2020 on higher education and its challenges but only few studies focused negative impact of the NEP 2020 on rural and traditional education system so that present study mainly focused in advantages and disadvantages of the NEP on rural education also discussed implementation and challenges, curriculum and pedagogical changes, lack of teacher education and training. In this way this study focused on ‘Impact of New Education Policy on Higher Education in Karnataka’.

III. Objectives of the study

- To examine the impact of National Education Policy 2020 on rural education.
- To advantage and disadvantages of NEP-2020 in Karnataka.

IV. Methodology

The methodology consists of a conceptual discussion on highlighting the idea of the national educational policy framework, highlighting various sections of the policy of NEP 2020 in relation to Higher Education in Karnataka and to study the impact of NEP on Higher Education is made using the group discussion method. The advantage and disadvantages of the new policy related to Higher Education in Karnataka are analyzed using the descriptive analysis technique.

V. Discussion of the study

5.1: Impact of National Education Policy 2020 (NEP) on Higher Education in Karnataka

The National Education Policy 2020 (NEP) has implications for higher education not just at the national level but also at the state level, including Karnataka. While the NEP provides a broad framework, it is up to the state governments to implement and adapt the policy guidelines according to their specific context. Here are some potential impacts of the NEP on higher education in Karnataka:

Restructuring of undergraduate programs: The NEP recommends a four-year undergraduate program with multiple exit options, allowing students to receive a certificate, diploma, or degree based on the duration of their study. This flexibility in the undergraduate curriculum can be implemented in Karnataka's higher education institutions, enabling students to customize their education and acquire skills relevant to their career aspiration

Multidisciplinary approach: The NEP encourages a multidisciplinary approach to higher education, promoting the integration of arts and sciences, professional and vocational education, and academic and extracurricular activities. Karnataka's higher education institutions can align their programs with this approach, offering interdisciplinary courses and encouraging collaboration across different disciplines.

Focus on research and innovation: The NEP emphasizes the importance of research and innovation in higher education. It encourages the establishment of research infrastructure, funding mechanisms, and collaborations with industries and research institutions. Karnataka's higher education institutions can leverage this emphasis to strengthen their research culture, facilitate industry-academia partnerships, and promote innovation and entrepreneurship.

Quality enhancement and accreditation: The NEP emphasizes the need for a robust accreditation framework to ensure quality standards in higher education. Karnataka can establish a strong accreditation system aligned with the NEP guidelines, ensuring that institutions in the state maintain high-quality teaching and learning practices. This can contribute to the overall improvement of higher education in Karnataka.

Technology integration and online learning: The NEP recognizes the significance of technology in education and promotes the integration of online and digital learning platforms. Karnataka's higher education institutions can embrace technology-enabled teaching and learning practices, providing access to quality education to a larger number of students, promoting remote learning, and leveraging digital resources for improved learning outcomes.

Faculty development: The NEP acknowledges the crucial role of faculty in higher education and emphasizes their professional development. Karnataka can support faculty development initiatives, such as training programs, workshops, and research grants, to enhance the teaching and research capabilities of faculty members in the state's higher education institutions.

Professional development of faculty: The NEP recognizes the critical role of faculty in higher education and emphasizes their professional development. It recommends regular training and development programs for faculty members to upgrade their teaching and research skills. The policy also promotes a flexible faculty mobility program, allowing faculty to engage in industry collaborations, research projects, and sabbaticals.

Overall, the National Education Policy 2020 aims to bring about a transformative change in higher education by fostering a student-centric, flexible, and quality-oriented system. It seeks to align higher education with the evolving needs of society, promote interdisciplinary learning, encourage research and innovation, and enhance the global standing of Indian institutions. However, the successful implementation of the NEP requires collaborative efforts from various including the government, educational institutions, faculty, students, and the wider society.

5.2: Disadvantages of National Education Policy 2020 (NEP) on Higher Education

While the National Education Policy 2020 (NEP) brings several advantages to higher education, there are also potential disadvantages or challenges associated with its implementation. Here are some of the perceived disadvantages of the NEP on higher education:

Implementation challenges: Implementing a comprehensive policy like the NEP requires substantial resources, infrastructure, and coordination among various stakeholders. The effective execution of the NEP at the ground level may face challenges such as lack of funding, limited institutional capacity, and difficulties in aligning diverse educational institutions with the new policy framework.

Unequal access and equity: While the NEP aim to promote inclusive education, there is a concern that it may exacerbate existing inequalities in access to higher education. The implementation of flexible exit options and multidisciplinary approaches may disproportionately benefit students from privileged backgrounds, as they may have better access to resources and guidance to make informed decisions. This can widen the gap between disadvantaged students and their more privileged counterparts.

Quality control and accreditation: While the NEP emphasizes quality assurance through accreditation, there may be challenges in establishing and maintaining a robust accreditation framework. Ensuring consistent quality across diverse higher education institutions, especially in remote areas or with limited resources, may be challenging. The effectiveness and credibility of the accreditation process will be crucial to maintain the desired quality standards.

Faculty development and capacity building: The NEP recognizes the importance of faculty development, but implementing comprehensive faculty training programs across all higher education institutions may be a challenge. Lack of adequate resources, limited access to professional development opportunities, and resistance to change from some faculty members can hinder the successful implementation of faculty development initiatives.

Transition and adaptation period: The NEP introduces significant changes to the higher education system, including restructuring undergraduate programs, integrating technology, and promoting research and innovation. The transition period and adaptation to these changes may cause initial disruption and resistance from educational institutions, faculty, and students. It will require effective planning, support, and monitoring to ensure a smooth transition.

Evaluation and assessment methods: The NEP emphasizes a shift from rote learning to competency-based education. However, developing and implementing effective evaluation and assessment methods to measure competencies and skills can be a complex task. The design and implementation of reliable and valid assessment tools to evaluate student learning outcomes aligned with the NEP objectives may pose a challenge.

Rural and remote areas: The NEP aims to address the disparities between urban and rural areas in terms of access to quality education. However, implementing the NEP's provisions effectively in remote and rural areas, where infrastructure, resources, and qualified faculty may be limited, can be a significant challenge. Ensuring equal access and quality education across all regions of the country will require substantial investment and targeted efforts.

5.3: Issues with the New Education Policy-2020 in Karnataka

- Lack of integration, Lack of technical knowledge and language barrier in rural education.
- Lack of funds to invest on higher education.
- Institutional limitations and Issues with examinations.
- There is a persistent mismatch between skill and knowledge.
- NEP 2020- failed to handle technical educations like artificial intelligence and cyberspace.
- Reduces the student gross enrollment ratio in higher education.
- NEP 2020- effected on workload of the teachers and it raises the educational unemployment in Karnataka.
- Unrealistic concepts of multidisciplinary courses in higher education.

VI. Conclusion:

The new national education policy 2020 is a good policy as it aims at making the education system holistic flexible multi-disciplinary align to the needs of 21st century and the 2030 sustainable development goals. The NEP is a product of an extensive exercise that strives to achieve 100% gross enrolment ratio by 2030. With an aim to create a more inclusive cohesive and productive nation the recently unveiled national education policy 2020 has come a groundbreaking reform by the Ministry of human resource development MHRD. The intent of policy seems to be ideal in many ways but it is the implementation where lies the key to success. Under the NEP 2020, the focus areas of the reforms seek to cultivate 21st century skills among students including critical thinking problem solving creativity and digital literacy. As technological advancements rapid globalization and unprecedented developments such as the covid-19 pandemic-transform the future of work, the existing education models need to be reassessed in keeping with the challenges of the global economy.

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